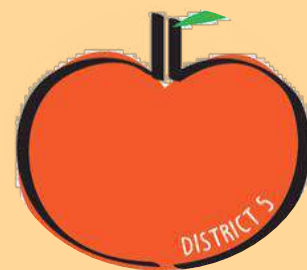


District 5 Newsletter

1ST QUARTER—2021

District 5 Newsletter Editor: Vicki R. / Orange
Online Newsletter: <https://msca09aa.org/districts/>

DOES YOUR GROUP HAVE A VOICE?

GENERAL SERVICE REPRESENTATIVE (GSR)

"The general service representatives (G.S.R.s) of the U.S. and Canada are the very foundation of our general service structure. Through your G.S.R., you can make your group's voice heard at district meetings, at area assemblies, and eventually at the General Service Conference."

For more information about GSRs, see A.A.® leaflet:

A.A. Pamphlet: P-19 -

"G.S.R. Your group's link to A.A. as a whole"

"For a new general service representative, this leaflet outlines responsibilities and useful sources of information; for a group, what to keep in mind when electing a G.S.R."
~ Alcoholic Anonymous © (A.A.)



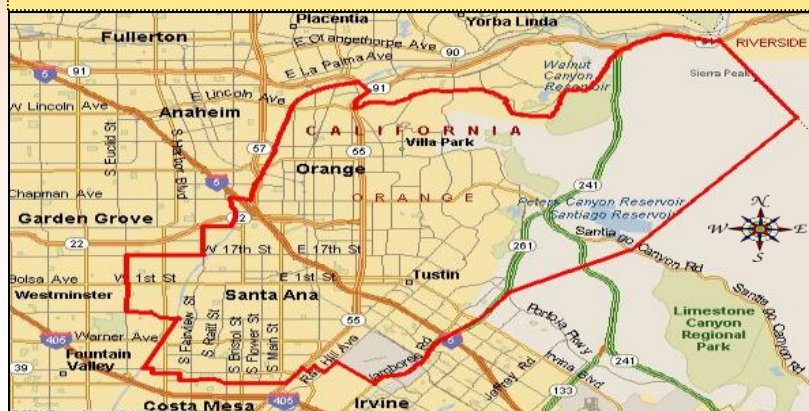
The AA SERVICE MANUAL

Combined with TWELVE CONCEPTS for WORLD SERVICE
(.pdf version)

https://www.aa.org/assets/en_US/en_bm-31.pdf

"DISTRICT 5 AREA ZONES"

**Cowan Heights, Lemon Heights, Orange,
Orange Park Acres, (parts of) Santa Ana, Tustin, and Villa Park**



Being of Service...

**YOUR DISTRICT 5 TRUSTED SERVANTS
...OFFICERS AND COMMITTEE MEMBERS...**

OFFICERS

DISTRICT COMMITTEE MEMBER CHAIR (D.C.M.C.)	RYAN H. (hvacman25@gmail.com)
ALTERNATE DISTRICT COMMITTEE MEMBER CHAIR (ALT. D.C.M.C.)	ISAAC M. (isaacmaganazo@gmail.com)
SECRETARY	CHRIS W. (cwheelerx@gmail.com)
TREASURER	VICKI R. (wrkaaitwrks@aol.com)
REGISTRAR	DAVID H. (davwhort@gmail.com)

DISTRICT COMMITTEE MEMBERS (DCMs)

WOMEN'S DAY	OPEN (Your Name??)
WOMEN'S EVENING	OPEN (Your Name??)
MEN'S GROUP	DAVID H.
ORANGE	OPEN (Your Name??)
WEST ORANGE	GREG A.
(ORANGE) FRIENDSHIP CLUB AM	OPEN (Your Name??)
(ORANGE) FRIENDSHIP CLUB PM	CHRISTINA W.
SANTA ANA ALANO CLUB	OPEN (Your Name??)
SANTA ANA	CASEY D.
NORTH TUSTIN	STEVE C.
SOUTH TUSTIN	STEVE C.

STANDING COMMITTEES CHAIRS

ACCESSIBILITIES	OPEN (Your Name??)
ARCHIVES	BRUCE M.
COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY (C.P.C.)	OPEN (Your Name??)
CONVENTION LIAISON	ROB B.
GRAPEVINE	KYLE B.
GSR SCHOOL	ROB S.
HOSPITALS & INSTITUTIONS (H&I) LIAISON	LINDSEY K.
INTERGROUP LIAISON	SCOTT B.
LITERATURE	GLENDIA R.
NEWSLETTER	VICKI R.
PUBLIC INFORMATION (P.I.)	OPEN (Your Name??)

VOLUNTEER POSITIONS

CAKE SERVICES	DAVID H.
COFFEE	DAVID H.

INSIDE THIS ISSUE:

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If you're interested in **being of service** and would like to be involved in "District 5" by volunteering for an **"OPEN"** commitment, please join us at the next District 5 meeting and let us know. We'd love to have you join us!!

If there's something you'd like to see in a future newsletter, please let me know. Vicki R. / District 5 Newsletter Editor



STEPS, TRADITIONS, AND CONCEPTS OF A.A.

(Reprinted with permission of A.A. World Services, Inc.)



STEPS: 1 THRU 3

1.

"We admitted we were powerless over alcohol—that our lives had become unmanageable."

2.

"Came to believe that a Power greater than ourselves could restore us to sanity."

3.

"Made a decision to turn our will and our lives over to the care of God as we understood Him."

SANITY (Step #2): "soundness of mind or judgment / mentally sound and healthy / reasonable / compatible with a socially accepted point of view / having a "normal" healthy mind / able to make sound rational judgments" The Little Big Book Dictionary-Gold Edition-April 2009

TRADITIONS: 1 THRU 3

1.

Short Form:

"Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity."

2.

Short Form:

"For our group purpose there is but one ultimate authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern."

3.

Short Form:

"The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking."

UNITY (Tradition #1): "singleness / the state or quality of being one" The Little Big Book Dictionary-Gold Edition-April 2009

CONCEPTS: 1 THRU 3

1.

Short Form:

"Final responsibility and ultimate authority for A.A. world services should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship."

2.

Short Form:

"The General Service Conference of A.A. has become, for nearly every practical purpose, the active voice and the effective conscience of our whole society in its world affairs."

3.

Short Form:

"The Conference shall observe the spirit of A.A. tradition, taking care that it never becomes the seat of perilous wealth or power; that sufficient operating funds and reserve be its prudent financial principle; that it place none of its members in a position of unqualified authority over others; that it reach all important decisions by discussion, vote, and whenever possible, substantial unanimity; that its actions never be personally punitive nor an incitement to public controversy; that it never perform acts of government; that, like the Society it serves, it will always remain democratic in thought and action."

COLLECTIVE (Concept #1): "as a whole / as a combined or assembled group of individuals" The Little Big Book Dictionary-Gold Edition-April 2009

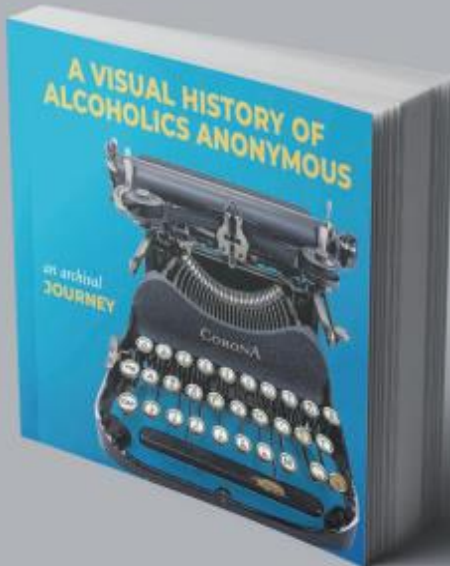


— “GSO NEWS” —

“A VISUAL HISTORY OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS”

“Originally developed as the souvenir book for the 2020 International Convention in Detroit, this colorful, gift-sized volume serves as both a lavishly illustrated tour through A.A.’s history and a lively celebration of our Fellowship. Powerful images — some never before published — and short descriptive texts walk us through the people, places and things integral to A.A.’s early growth, and forward to today’s vibrant, international Fellowship. Also included is a highlight on the Virtual 2020 International Convention, a special focus on A.A. in Detroit, and updated coverage of recent digital innovations in A.A. group life.”

AVAILABLE FEBRUARY 14, 2021
 (“A Valentine’s Day Gift to the Fellowship”)



GSO FINANCIAL REPORT

(Per “Quarterly Report from G.S.O. – November 2020”)

FINANCIAL DATA: For the nine months ended 9/30/2020 (All figures pending final C.P.A. audit)

G.S.O.	2020 Budget	2020 Actual	2019 Actual
Contributions from A.A. groups and members	\$10,173,870	\$ 7,351,086	\$ 6,197,296
Sales less cost of production and shipping	6,202,068	5,326,244	7,291,987
Interest Income	0	0	0
Total Income	16,375,938	12,677,330	13,489,283
Total G.S.O. expenses:	16,713,065	11,882,137	14,115,011
Net Operating Income (expense)	(337,127)	795,193	(625,728)
AA GRAPEVINE, INC.			
Sales less costs of products	\$ 1,499,623	\$ 1,019,663	\$ 1,397,949
Interest earned — Reserve Fund	22,500	22,500	23,418
Total Income	1,522,123	1,042,163	1,421,367
Expenses	1,484,526	1,349,458	1,583,173
Income (loss) from operations	37,597	(307,295)	(161,806)
General Service Board Support of La Viña shortfall	(237,768)	(252,080)	(110,499)

Alcoholics Anonymous : Videos and Audios (aa.org)

https://www.aa.org/pages/en_US/videos-and-audios#en_lb

“Sound and visual media help to carry the message of recovery of Alcoholics Anonymous and to inform the public and professionals about A.A. Public Service Announcements (PSAs) are available in both video and audio formats (for television and radio broadcast), as well as other materials specifically for young people and for professionals working with alcoholics.”

A.A.® Guidelines Internet (AA.org)

5.5M – 1/20 (GP) Rev. 11/18 MG-18

“A.A. Guidelines are compiled from the shared experience of A.A. members in various service areas. They also reflect guidance given through the Twelve Traditions and the General Service Conference (U.S. and Canada). In keeping with our Tradition of autonomy, except in matters affecting other groups or A.A. as a whole, most decisions are made by the group conscience of the members involved. The purpose of these Guidelines is to assist in reaching an informed group conscience.”

For full guidelines, go to:

https://www.aa.org/assets/en_US/mg-18_internet.pdf

FOR MORE “GSO NEWS” visit “What’s New on A.A.org”

https://www.aa.org/pages/en_US/whats-new-on-aaorg

— “MSCA09 NEWS” —

MSCA09’S NEW WEBSITE WENT LIVE ON JANUARY 8, 2021!

Be sure to check it out at: <https://msca09aa.org>

MSCA09’S new webmaster is Faith B.

Welcome and thank you, Faith, for taking on this commitment!



~~~~~  
 A special THANKS to Rainer F.  
 for his 10 years of Area 09 webmaster service!

District 5 truly appreciates all that he did in order to get our event flyers, newsletters, etc., etc., uploaded to District 5’s webpage on MSCA09’s (old) website in such an amazingly timely manner!  
 “He rocks!”

Our Area 09 Delegate, Ed L., shared a new message (dated Jan. 10, 2021) on his “Delegate’s Sharing Session” webpage of Area 09’s website.

(This is the latest one at the time of the issuance of this newsletter.)

### HAVE YOU CHECKED OUT THESE NEW APPS YET??

Just a reminder that Alex W. (District 1) has created a GSR and DCM phone app.

#### GSR APP:

<https://msca-gsr-kit.glideapp.io/>

#### DCM APP:

<https://dcm-dcmc-school-app.glideapp.io/>

*These are great and useful apps, so be sure and check them out! They can be downloaded to your computer, laptop, tablet, and/or netbook.*



# UPCOMING SOBER EVENTS

## DISTRICT 5

Feb. 8, 2021 (Mon) 6pm:

### \*STEERING COMMITTEE MEETING\*

#### ZOOM:

Member ID: 457 182 8915  
Password/Passcode: 469764

Feb. 11, 2021 (Thurs) 7pm-8:30pm:

### \*GSR MEETING\*

#### ZOOM:

Member ID: 457 182 8915  
Password/Passcode: 469764

Feb. 20, 2021 (Sat) 9am-12pm

### \*CONCEPTS -5 THRU 8- WORKSHOP\*

#### ZOOM:

Member ID: 457 182 8915  
Password/Passcode: 469764

Mar. 8, 2021 (Mon) @ 6pm:

### \*STEERING COMMITTEE MEETING\*

#### ZOOM:

Member ID: 457 182 8915  
Password/Passcode: 469764

Mar. 11, 2021 (Thurs) @ 7pm-8:30pm:

### \*GSR MEETING\*

#### ZOOM:

Member ID: 457 182 8915  
Password/Passcode: 469764

Apr. 5, 2021 (Mon) @ 6pm:

### \*STEERING COMMITTEE MEETING\*

#### ZOOM:

Member ID: 457 182 8915  
Password/Passcode: 469764

Apr. 8, 2021 (Thurs) @ 7pm-8:30pm:

### \*GSR MEETING\*

#### ZOOM:

Member ID: 457 182 8915  
Password/Passcode: 469764

## AREA 09

Feb. 14, 2021 (Sun) 8:30am-2:30pm

### \*AREA SERVICE COMMITTEE (ASC)\*

#### ZOOM:

Meeting ID: 915 6890 0885  
Password/Passcode: service

Feb. 18, 2021 (Thurs) 7pm-8pm

### \*MSCA09 WEBSITE PRESENTATION\*

#### ZOOM:

Meeting ID: 861 4086 6994  
Password/Passcode: EMS

See Page 5 of newsletter for more info.

Mar. 14, 2021 (Sun) 8:30am-2:30pm

### \*AREA SERVICE COMMITTEE (ASC)\*

#### ZOOM:

Meeting ID: 915 6890 0885  
Password/Passcode: service

Mar. 18, 2021 (Thurs) 7pm-8pm

### \*HOW TO MAKE AN APP - PART 2\*

Meeting ID: 861 4086 6994  
Password/Passcode: EMS

See Page 5 of newsletter for more info.

Apr. 11, 2021 (Sun) 8:30am-2:30pm

### \*AREA 09

### PRE-CONFERENCE WORKSHOP\*

No further info as of the  
issuance of this newsletter.



Mid-Southern  
California Area 09



Check Area 09's new website  
[www.msca09aa.org](http://www.msca09aa.org)  
for additional information on upcoming events.

## O.C. CENTRAL OFFICE

### O.C. INTERGROUP

Meetings are held every  
2nd Wednesday of the month at 7:00pm.

Be sure to confirm with the  
O.C. Central office (714-556-4555)  
beforehand whether meetings will be  
held in-person or via Zoom.

### IN-PERSON:

Costa Mesa Senior Center  
695 W. 19th Street, Costa Mesa

### ZOOM:

Meeting ID: 616 903 638  
Password/Passcode: ocaa

\*\*\*\*\*

### ORANGE COUNTY HOSPITALS & INSTITUTIONS (H&I)

Meets the 2nd Sunday of the month  
by Zoom at 4:00pm and 6:00pm.

Orientation starts at 5:00pm sharp; the room  
will be locked from 5:05pm until 5:40pm.

The Committee Meeting is at 6:00pm  
(meeting opens around 5:40pm).

### ZOOM:

Meeting ID: 819 0493 8488  
Password/Passcode: 788615

Be sure to confirm with the  
O.C. Central office (714-556-4555)  
beforehand whether meetings will be  
held in-person or via Zoom.

\*\*\*\*\*

For a list of  
'VIRTUAL' directory meetings:

<https://oc-aa.org/directory/VM3col.asp>

Visit [www.oc-aa.org](http://www.oc-aa.org) for  
additional information on upcoming events.

### Attention Meeting Group Secretaries / Treasurers.....

When sending a 7th Tradition donation to District 5 for your group, please notate the following information so that District 5 can be sure your meeting group receives acknowledgement, along with a receipt:

- (1) Group number (issued by the General Service Office)
- (2) Meeting group name and day & time of meeting
- (3) Name and mailing (or email) address of whom to send the receipt to.

If your group number isn't known, ask your GSR to speak to the "District 5" Registrar (David H.) at the next monthly District meeting. You can also request that information by sending him an email at: [dawwhort@gmail.com](mailto:dawwhort@gmail.com)

Address for Correspondence and 7th Tradition Donations: District 5, M.S.C.A - P.O. Box 3374, Tustin, CA 92781

"Zelle" info for 7th Tradition Donations: [wrkaaitwrks@aol.com](mailto:wrkaaitwrks@aol.com)

♦ If donating via "Zelle", please be sure to notate group number / group name in the memo area.



Thank  
You!

## UPCOMING SOBER EVENTS

(Continued...)



### \*FEBRUARY 2021\*

Feb. 18th, 7pm-8pm

**"MSCA09 WEBSITE PRESENTATION"**

MSCA09 Electronic Media Sub-Committee Presents

## Website Q&A

ALL AA Members are welcome to come out preview, share and make any suggestions for their new website

**Zoom Meeting: 861 4086 6994**

**Passcode: EMS**

**February 18th 7-8pm**

Feb. 20th, 9am-12pm

**"CONCEPTS - 5 THRU 8 - WORKSHOP"**

## Workshop

# A.A. CONCEPTS - 5 thru 8 - WORKSHOP

Hosted by District 5

After such an informative and successful "Concepts 1 thru 4 Workshop", we're really looking forward to this one! All fellowships members are invited to join us!

**Date and Time**

**-Saturday-  
February 20, 2021  
9:00am - 12:00pm**

**Zoom Meeting ID:  
457 182 8915**

**Password:  
469764**

**~ PRESENTERS ~**

Concept 1: TBA

Concept 2: TBA

Concept 3: TBA

Concept 4: TBA

**LINKS TO THE TWELVE CONCEPTS**

- BM-31 - The A.A. Service Manual combined with Twelve Concepts for World Service - by Bill W. ([www.aa.org/assets/en\\_US/en\\_bm-31.pdf](http://www.aa.org/assets/en_US/en_bm-31.pdf))
- SMP-195\_en - The Twelve Concepts for World Service (Long Form) (aa.org) ([www.aa.org/assets/en\\_US/smp-195\\_en.pdf](http://www.aa.org/assets/en_US/smp-195_en.pdf))

**"GSR TOOL KIT" LINK**

GSR Tool Kit - Home - Made with Glide ([glideapp.io](https://msca-gsr-kit.glideapp.io/)) ([https://msca-gsr-kit.glideapp.io](https://msca-gsr-kit.glideapp.io/))

Stay tuned for more info on District 5's "Concept 9 thru 12 Workshop", which will be held in March 2021.

Please Note: Flyer will be updated once all details are finalized.





## **UPCOMING SOBER EVENTS** (Continued...)

### **\*MARCH 2021\***

**Mar. 5th - 7th**

**“PACIFIC REGION A.A.  
SERVICE ASSEMBLY 2021”**



***Hosted by***

***Area 93  
Central California***

***Virtual Event!***

***Registration is \$15.00***

***For more info:***

***<https://www.praasa.org>***

**Mar. 18th, 7pm-9pm**

**“HOW TO MAKE AN APP - PART 2”**

**Presented by MSCA09**

MSCA09 ELECTRONIC MEDIA SUB-COMMITTEE  
PRESENTS

## **HOW TO MAKE AN APP PART 2**

Zoom Meeting:  
861 4086 6994  
Passcode: EMS

- \* Learn how to make an app
- \* How to update it
- \* How to navigate
- \* Be tasked with the creation of your own app

All AA members are encouraged to participate.

March 18th  
7-9:00pm



***Be sure to let both DISTRICT 5 and O.C. CENTRAL OFFICE know if your meeting group is holding virtual meetings, has gone back to 'live' meetings, or has disbanded.***



## DISTRICT 5 \*\*\* SOBRIETY BIRTHDAYS \*\*

Those listed below attended the District 5 'Zoom' Meeting the month of their sobriety birthday. CONGRATS TO ALL!



### \*\*NOVEMBER 2020\*\*

- \* **David H. (3 Yrs.) :** GSR ("Sat Night Visiting Speakers" - Orange)  
 ..... Alt. GSR ("How It Works" - Orange)  
 ..... Cake & Coffee Services and Registrar (District 5)
- \* **Christina W. (2 Yrs.) :** GSR ("Thursday Noon Discussion Group" - Orange)  
 ..... DCM-Friendship Club (District 5)



### \*\*DECEMBER 2020\*\*

NO BIRTHDAYS



By doing it  
"ONE DAY AT A TIME",  
all together they have...

YEARS.....5  
 MONTHS .....60  
 WEEKS.....260  
 DAYS .....1,825  
 HOURS .....4,380  
 MINUTES .....2,628,000



### GSO...THE BIRTHDAY PLAN

"Contributions to the General Service Office support G.S.O.'s services to members and groups throughout Canada and the U.S. and help ensure that the A.A. message is carried around the world. The services that the G.S.O. provides the A.A. groups cost more than \$6 per member per year. Members customarily contribute \$1, \$2 or even \$5 a year for each year of sobriety—others may give a penny or a nickel a day for each day of their sobriety."

For More Info: [www.aa.org/pages/en\\_US/the-birthday-plan](http://www.aa.org/pages/en_US/the-birthday-plan)



- ♦ Alcoholics Anonymous.....[www.aa.org](http://www.aa.org)
- ♦ MSCA 09 / District 5.....[www.msca09aa.org](http://www.msca09aa.org)
- ♦ OC Central Office.....[www.oc-aa.org](http://www.oc-aa.org)
- ♦ A.A. Service Manual Combined with 12 Concepts (2018-20)  
 ..... [https://www.aa.org/assets/en\\_US/en\\_bm-31.pdf](https://www.aa.org/assets/en_US/en_bm-31.pdf)
- ♦ AA Grapevine.....[www.aagrapevine.org](http://www.aagrapevine.org)
- ♦ AA Grapevine YouTube .. <https://www.youtube.com/aagrapevine>
- ♦ OC A.A. Convention .....[www.oacaac.org](http://www.oacaac.org)
- ♦ AA Online Intergroup .....[www.aa-intergroup.org](http://www.aa-intergroup.org)
- ♦ All O.C. Young People In A.A.....[www.aocypaa.org](http://www.aocypaa.org)

### NEW GSRs / Alternate GSRs!!!

A big **WELCOME** and **THANK YOU** to the  
following new GSRs and/or Alternate GSRs...

| NAME             | GROUP                     | CITY   |
|------------------|---------------------------|--------|
| ♦ Roger F. (GSR) | Hart Park Newcomers Group | Orange |



### AA RESPONSIBILITY STATEMENT

*"I am Responsible. When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help,  
I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible."*

**FRIENDLY REMINDER...** The General Service Office needs to be advised whenever there are the following meeting/group changes, so that they can keep their records up to date.

- Name – Date and Time – Location
- General Service Representative (GSR) and/or Contact Information (i.e. Secretary)
- Disbandment of Meeting/Group

If there are any changes, please be sure to notify your District 5 Registrar (*David H.*) via email, or by attending a virtual "Zoom" District 5 meeting and giving David H. 'or' Rob S. (GSR School) the applicable information. District 5 will enter the information into their database and then forward it onto Area 09 for entering into their database. They will then forward it onto the General Service Office.

\*\*You can find information on the next "District 5" meeting on Page 4 (*Upcoming Sober Events* of this newsletter.\*\*



## ...FELLOWSHIP MEMBER CONTRIBUTION...

Serve because you  
want to be useful  
to others, not  
because you want  
to be praised.

©QuotesEmpire.com

### Service

Older ladies in their twenties and thirties were the first AAs to teach me about service. With only several months of sobriety and with a demonstrated track record of showing up for the Saturday morning eatin' meetin' in Victorville, California, these women in their sixties and seventies with twenty to thirty years of sobriety nominated-and-elected me (in what seemed to be the same breath) as their secretary. Perhaps they knew that my then-inflated ego would jump at the opportunity to lead them into sobriety, and that in so leaping, I would dive into the deep end of their soothing pool of sober service. Thinking I would lead them into sobriety, they gently led me one rung lower on the upside-down ladder of AA service. That was 15 years ago, and recently, Barb reminisced with me about beginning sobriety in the warmth of their menopausal hot flashes.

In his term as Pacific Regional Trustee for Panels 64 through 67, Joel put into words the very thing that then and now characterizes my AA service when he said, "Do it but don't want it." And as I've learned in most of my Ninth Step amends, expectations rarely reflect reality. For example, when I was elected secretary for the Saturday night meeting in Wrightwood, where the soft glow of candles lent certain anonymity to my candid honesty, my nervousness peaked on that very first night when I turned the key in the unlit lock of the church door. Thinking I would perform feats of grandeur while being of humble service, my newcomer nerves settled down when the warm, welcoming alcoholics showed up and showed me that opening the door was the extent of what they expected of me. And, I learned that *they plus me equals we*. No longer alone!

A year later in that same candlelit room, I sat at the end of the table jotting down another AAism ("We're all here because we're not all there"), when upon hearing my name, I looked up into the smiling eyes of a dozen alcoholics who had just elected me as Wrightwood's very first GSR. As is often said, it took me about two years to learn what my two-year commitment entailed. Frustration and judgment taught me patience and tolerance when at the end of two years I couldn't interest another alcoholic in replacing me. So, ten years before I heard Joel say it, I willingly did what I lacked the ambition to do.

Then I learned about the Spirit of Rotation through the Spirit of Stagnation. Having been a recording secretary for another nonprofit for ten years, I willingly accepted the position of District 19 Secretary when Bob O of Barstow resigned six months into his two year commitment. So, for those one-and-a-half years, the next two as the officially elected secretary, and the subsequent two years when the then-elected secretary resigned after a month, I attended District 19 meetings for those five-and-a-half years deciphering the recordable from the un-recordable sober business of service-committed alcoholics. And, I learned that we rotate out to remain right-sized and to make way for the newcomer.

I glimpsed then what I later observed at the San Antonio International Convention. If you were there, you may recall that the San Antonio volunteers wore green t-shirts with 2010 printed across their shoulders. Sitting in the nosebleed section of the Alamodome behind the volunteers during the Saturday night sobriety countdown, ninety-five percent of the volunteers were still standing when those with twenty-five years or less of sobriety were asked to sit down. Alcoholics-in-service lead lives of long-termed sobriety.

Sad to say, serving two years as the Area 09 Grapevine Chair was like that seventies-famous repairman who sat lonely at the table hoping for customers. While Finance, Literature, CPC, and PI committees buzzed with enthusiasm and GSR and DCM Schools scurried with students, I sat beside my Grapevine displays, with only the occasional visitor, but mostly by myself promoting the only aspect of AA that allows promotion in addition to attraction: Grapevine! It was then that I felt most strongly that our *Responsibility* Pledge should be changed to our *Availability* Pledge: "Whenever anyone anywhere reaches out for help, I want the hand of AA to always be there, and for that I am *Available*!"

Having thus been bitten by the Grapevine bug, I recently completed a three-year term as a member of Grapevine's Editorial Advisory Board (which I had to vacate to serve as Area 09 delegate). What a wonder when I was invited as an EAB member in 2018 to step onto the very lowest rungs of AA's ladder at the Crowne Plaza Times Square Manhattan hotel for the 68<sup>th</sup> General Service Conference in New York!

With experienced foreknowledge of secretarial responsibilities, I was happily elected into the position of Area 09 Secretary. At numerous round tables, from PRAASA (Pacific Regional AA Service Assemblies) to Pacific Regional Forums, at the registration table every second Sunday of the month in some new part of mid-southern California, and at Board meetings every third Sunday, I learned that District and Area secretaries give of themselves to inform the membership. With 980 active and inactive Area 09 members, frequent e-blasts were the norm of that position. And, I descended one more rung down the ladder into the AA service structure, where I've learned that the best AA has to offer is in its Trusted (General Service) Servants.

In October 2018, as I watched the new Panel 68 Area positions go to my friends in sobriety, it was with some desperation that I stood for Area Treasurer Accounts Receivable. And I was elected into a position for which I had no clue. In fact on January 22<sup>nd</sup> of that year, I made my first bank deposit in 31 years; my wife having done all of our personal and business banking in the meantime. How touched I was that first month to receive 250 Area contributions, ranging from \$1.47 up to \$450, from both the poor and rich parts of mid-southern California.

Two months into that position, our Alternate Delegate stepped down and I heard the three most exciting and daunting words in AA: "R U willing?" It was then that Joel's words comforted me: Do it without wanting it. After the vote, in typical AA fashion, I was congratulated by the other officers on my demotion! And, now I'm the Area 09 delegate, with a small "d."

More *has been* revealed. I've learned that service is like walking a tightrope but with the added security of AA's safety net: embraced by sober alcoholics who have come and gone before; doing each next indicated step, matching fear with faith; learning our codes of patience and tolerance; exercising humility as a cure for ego; listening as one alcoholic talks to another in meeting halls, convention halls, and sports stadiums; and, when all else fails, stop taking myself so damned seriously!

Ed L., Area 09, Panel 70 delegate



## A.A. IN THE NEWS... "1940"

Evening Star  
(Washington, D.C.)

June 17, 1940

- 5th Article of Series-

### Alcoholics Anonymous Find Friendly Approach Works

Organization Often Makes Progress Where Drinker's Family Fails

(No. 5 of a Series.)

By ROBERT A. ERWIN.

Wives and children inevitably fit into the jigsaw puzzle life of confirmed alcoholics. In fact, the family often has to make a career of trying to straighten up the head of the house who has a weakness for the bottle. Often as not they have failed, and in many cases of failure Alcoholics Anonymous has succeeded, picking up where the family left off.

In one way or another Mr. Y has had his place in this series before. He has been marked as an ex-salesman and gentleman farmer, a leader and confirmed believer in the A. A.'s, now devoting most of his time to the cause after having left a trail of alcoholic antics through the years.

Because the approach of the double A's worked with him, Mr. Y has more than usual respect for his own father-in-law, who once applied that practical approach to him.

#### Nothing But Friendship.

"My friends and my minister could never reach me," he said recently in a talk before the club. "My father-in-law knew me well. I'd drink my own liquor and then I'd steal his. He had no alcoholic problem, because he could control his drinking. I'll say one thing for him, he never tried to hide a bottle on me."

"Finally," Mr. Y related, "my wife had left me. The father-in-law came to see me. He found me alone, ready to listen to preaching and ready to put up a defense of myself. Much to my surprise he brought me a pint of whisky. 'I thought you were lonely,' he told me, 'and out of liquor as well, so I brought you some of my own.'"

"The father-in-law got as near my

level as a non-alcoholic could," said Mr. Y. "He even told me how he had been drunk one time. He gave me no criticism, nothing but friendship. He was dealing with me as if I were a sick man who had a disease, and that's what I had."

"Until I got ahold of this line of thought, I didn't want to stop. I wasn't so extremely sincere. And so it came about that I started to get away from myself, I became interested in the welfare of my fellowmen from the standpoint of brotherly love. Here was the real answer. It was like seeking a fresh stream of water."

#### Process Slow in Some.

"As for the religious approach, let us simply say that we shall desire to love our neighbors as ourselves."

Let's try to reach the other fellows who really are suffering as we have suffered.

"Take what you can from here and practice it in your daily life," Mr. Y advised. "If you follow this creed, you need have no worries as to alcoholism. The process is slow in some, fast in others. Often it depends on others than the alcoholic in his family. I once saw seven people in a family get straight in their thinking before they could straighten out their alcoholic kinsman. They realized they had been intolerant. When they began to concentrate on a sick man, they began to get results."

The case of Mr. Y is quite typical. He and his brothers and sisters of the Washington Chapter of Alcoholics Anonymous realize they have a field here, first among their own friends and among those who establish contact with the organization. It was pointed out in one meeting that Washington has the second highest mortality rate from alcoholism in the United States. In per capita consumption of alcoholic beverages, Washington is not second. It is first.

(Please excuse the poor quality of these newspaper clippings.)

Robert A. Erwin's articles 1 thru 4 of his series appear in the following District 5 newsletters:

- ♦ Article 1: "Issue 17 — 2nd Quarter 2020"
- ♦ Article 2: "Issue 18 — 3rd Quarter 2020"
- ♦ Article 3 & 4: "Issue 19 — 4th Quarter 2020"

Evening Star  
(Washington, D.C.)

June 18, 1940

- 6th Article of Series -

### Society Witnesses Amazing Comebacks By Drink Victims

Alcoholics Anonymous Foster Salvaging of Wrecked Lives

(No. 6 of a Series.)

By ROBERT A. ERWIN.

There's a melodramatic touch to some of the achievements of Alcoholics Anonymous. In the ranks of these ex-rummies are men who have lost everything, their family, their homes and their jobs, men over whom society has counted "10—and out." Yet, they're coming back, undoubtedly much to the surprise of those who once cast them aside.

One of the best examples of this achievement, without much economic wreckage, however, is that of a young engineer, member of a distinguished family. He has been through the mill, the rum, whisky, beer, gin and every other alcoholic mill. Just to give him a name, we will call him Mr. A.

Mr. A picked up the pieces before it was too late. When he put them back together, he had a picture he never had seen before. He proved what the psychiatrists contend about confirmed alcoholics; namely, that to overcome the disease, they must clean house completely and find a new way of living.

#### Recounts Story.

Sitting behind the little square table in front of the clubroom where the Double A's meet each Tuesday night, Mr. A told his own story.

"My employers did the best they could with me," he said. "They tried to get me to quit drinking. I did quit for a while, but they were afraid. I had charge of a big project and had been on the wagon. I got so confident of myself that I started drinking beer. Next came wine, then whisky, and I was gone again. The job was gone, too."

"That taught me a lesson," he continued, "and then Alcoholics Anonymous came along. I saw the light. I came back to a job from which I had been fired once before, and it's one of the best jobs I've ever had."

#### New Friends Necessary.

At this point, Mr. A. told where his friends come in.

"They see you again, and they offer you a drink," he related. "You have nothing in common with them. Boys, it won't work. Find yourself some new friends, friends who are willing to let you live your own life. If they don't like you because you don't drink, they aren't worth having."

In this thesis, Mr. A's colleagues concur 100 per cent. So does their doctor friend and adviser.

Reaching our conclusion, the question arises, where does Alcoholics Anonymous go from here? Under its own steam, it is bound to go ahead. With some co-operation and a new viewpoint from the public, the results will be even greater.

The doctor friend of the Washington A. A.'s has suggested there should be "a free institution for alcoholics, and then a place like this. I once told a police judge that three months on the rockpile for a drunk isn't the answer. If a bunch of narcotic peddlers and addicts turn up the police turn out everything but the hook and ladder trucks. The public becomes aroused. When the people see an alcoholic they laugh."

#### Churches Co-operating.

In recent months the Washington Federation of Churches has become interested in the A. A. movement and in collaboration with the Life Adjustment Center, 1464 Columbia Road N.W., has assisted several A. A.s in securing employment.

"We are quite interested in the program and have discussed it with ministers in the city from time to time," said John L. Mixon, director of social welfare for the federation.

Authorities on alcoholism recognize the great value of medical treatment and, in a majority of cases, the necessity for it. Medical care often has brought back victims of drink to the point where they are receptive to Alcoholics Anonymous. Doctors and local institutions have co-operated in sending their patients to the meetings.

#### 500 Recoveries in a Year.

Part of the clue to the future is in the record of Alcoholics Anonymous for 1939. In that year the A. A.'s accomplished more than in the three years before. They counted 500 recoveries from alcoholism. The organization spread in its own simple, quiet way into many big cities. Washington is one of them.

Alcoholic Anonymous, as already has been mentioned, conducts national business through the mail address of Alcoholic Foundation, Box 658, Church street annex post office, New York City. There is no post office box address here as yet.

Public interest in the movement here already has been reflected by the number of letters and telephone calls received by The Star, many from people who have a friend or a relative whom they feel that Alcoholics Anonymous can help.

#### About the Writer:

Robert Amos Erwin was a correspondent for the Evening Star. He was born in Oct. 1908 in Evansville, Indiana, and died in Jan. 1978 in Washington, District of Columbia.

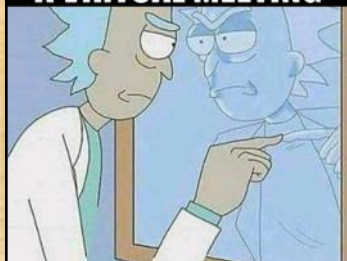
Additional articles, if found, will be included in future newsletters.



## MEETINGS / GROUPS WITH ACTIVE GSR PARTICIPATION IN 4TH QUARTER 2020

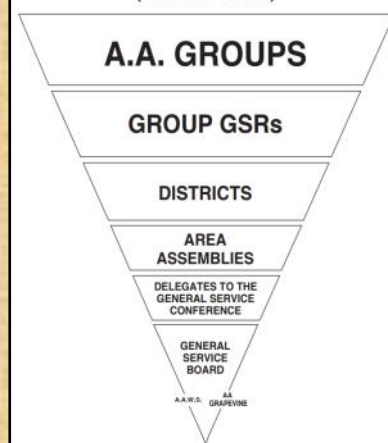
| NAME OF MEETING GROUP                    | LOCATION        | GSR          | ALTERNATE G.S.R. |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------|------------------|
| 777 (Newcomers) Men's Stag Group         | Orange          | Robert B.    |                  |
| Chapman & Lewis AA Group                 | Orange          | Glenda R.    |                  |
| Crawl Before No One (F/Club)             | Orange          | Bruce M.     |                  |
| Forever Non-Professional (F/Club)        | Orange          | Chris W.     |                  |
| Friday On A Monday Discussion            | Orange          | Chris H.     |                  |
| Hart Park Newcomers Group                | Orange          | Roger F.     |                  |
| How It Works                             | Orange          | Steve C.     | David H.         |
| It's In the Book                         | Tustin          | Gloria Z.    |                  |
| Keep it Simple Group                     | Orange          | Michelle H.  |                  |
| Men's BYOB Book Study                    | Tustin          | Matt D.      |                  |
| Name in the Hat Group                    | Orange          | Scott B.     |                  |
| Not A Glum Lot                           | Orange          | Charley R.   |                  |
| Not A Perfect Circle                     | Orange          | Chris W.     |                  |
| Saturday Night Visiting Speakers Mtg.    | Orange          | David H.     |                  |
| Sunday Morning B/B Study Group           | Orange          | Greg A.      |                  |
| Sunday Night Speakers Meeting of Orange  | Orange          | Manny A.     |                  |
| (The) Other 12 & 12 Group                | Orange          | Chris W.     |                  |
| Thur Nite New Comers Group               | Orange          | Jackie R.    |                  |
| Thursday Noon Discussion Group           | Orange          | Christina W. |                  |
| Tustin Big Book Study                    | Tustin          | Peter C.     |                  |
| Tustin Rush Hour                         | Tustin & Orange | Chuck W.     |                  |
| We Got A Coffee Pot                      | Orange          | Will G.      |                  |
| Wed Nite Womens Solutions Grp            | Tustin          | Kathy S.     |                  |
| Wednesday Noon Discussion Group (F/Club) | Orange          | Bruce M.     |                  |
| Womens Experience Strength & Hope        | Orange          | Kirin S.     |                  |

### WHEN YOU ARE THE FIRST PERSON TO JOIN A VIRTUAL MEETING



- Did you know that the local group is the basic unit of A.A. World Service?
- Does your meeting/group have a GSR?
- Has there been a GSR or Alt-GSR change?
- Is your meeting/group missing from the above

#### STRUCTURE OF THE CONFERENCE (U.S. and Canada)





*In keeping with our 7th Tradition.....*

## **“2020” GROUP DONATIONS MADE TO “DISTRICT 5”**

| GROUP #                  | GROUP NAME                         | CITY          | "2020"<br>GROUP TOTAL |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------|-----------------------|
| INDIVIDUAL               | Rob S.                             | Orange        | \$ 10.00              |
| INDIVIDUAL               | Ryan H.                            | Anaheim       | \$ 30.00              |
| 131258                   | 9:02 Group                         | Villa Park    | \$ 32.00              |
| 132752                   | All About Me Mens Stag Group       | Orange        | \$ 60.00              |
| 713798                   | AOCYPAA                            | Lag. Beach    | \$ 9.34               |
| 136826                   | As Bill Sees It                    | Orange        | \$ 15.00              |
| 712762                   | Attitude Adjustment (F/Club)       | Orange        | \$ 20.00              |
| ??                       | Desire to Stop - Sat. Mtg.         | Santa Ana     | \$ 10.00              |
| 126119                   | Early Birds Group                  | Orange        | \$ 51.59              |
| 632837                   | Foothill Early Risers              | Tustin        | \$ 44.16              |
| 725120                   | Forever Non-Professional           | Orange        | \$ 74.31              |
| ??                       | Friday Morning Men's Coffee        | Tustin        | \$ 12.00              |
| 126062                   | Friday Night No Puffers            | Orange        | \$ 20.00              |
| 275245                   | Friday On A Monday                 | Orange        | \$ 15.00              |
| 172225                   | How It Works                       | Orange        | \$ 15.00              |
| 680752                   | Keep It Simple Group               | Orange        | \$ 16.80              |
| 686410                   | Monday Night Mens B.Y.O.B.         | Tustin        | \$ 48.00              |
| 101386                   | Monday Night Men's Stag            | Lag. Beach    | \$ 74.70              |
| ??                       | Monday Night Speaker Meeting       | Orange        | \$ 8.41               |
| 670924                   | Not A Glum Lot                     | Orange        | \$ 10.00              |
| 100561                   | Sat. Night Visiting Speakers Mtg.  | Tustin        | \$ 16.10              |
| 616357                   | Sober & Crazy Speaker Meeting      | Orange        | \$ 60.95              |
| 146970                   | Sunday Morning B/B Study Group     | Orange        | \$ 47.00              |
| 655929                   | (The) Other 12 & 12 (Twin Towers)  | Orange        | \$ 66.00              |
| 722902                   | The Name in the Hat                | Orange        | \$ 66.00              |
| 696177                   | Tustin Acceptance Group            | Tustin        | \$ 42.00              |
| 130429                   | Tustin Attitude Modification Group | Tustin        | \$ 643.84             |
| 678232                   | Tustin Big Book Study              | Tustin        | \$ 36.21              |
| 168129                   | Tustin Rush Hour Group             | Tustin-Orange | \$ 17.81              |
| 179495                   | Wed Nite Womens Solutions Grp      | Tustin        | \$ 40.45              |
| 630797                   | Wednesday Morning Donuts Group     | Orange F/C    | \$ 50.00              |
| 135004                   | Winners Circle Group               | Anaheim       | \$ 20.00              |
| 638840                   | Womens Step Study Group            | Tustin        | \$ 20.00              |
| TOTAL DONATIONS RECEIVED |                                    |               | \$ 1,702.67           |

*If your meeting group, or you as an individual, would like to make a 7th Tradition donation to District 5, here are two options:*

### CHECK 'or' CASH

**District 5**  
**P.O. Box 3374**  
**Tustin, CA 92781**

### ZELLE

(c/o US Bank-District 5 Treasurer)

**Acct Info: [wrkaaitwrks@aol.com](mailto:wrkaaitwrks@aol.com)**

If applicable, please be sure to notate your meeting group name and, if known, group number.

**DISTRICT 5  
GREATLY  
APPRECIATES  
YOUR '2020'  
DONATIONS!**

| 2020 ACTUALS                                       |               |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| BEGINNING BALANCE                                  | \$ 4,468.79   |
| TOTAL DONATIONS RECEIVED                           | \$ 1,702.67   |
| TOTAL BEGINNING BALANCE AND DONATIONS              | \$ 6,171.46   |
| TOTAL EXPENSES PAID                                | \$ (2,980.72) |
| ENDING TREASURY BALANCE                            | \$ 3,190.74   |
| DIFF. BETWEEN DONATIONS RECEIVED AND EXPENSES PAID | \$ (1,278.05) |

Thank you for  
your support!

Ending this issue with a little fun...

## WORD SEARCH

### “FROM CONCEPTS III (3)”

The A.A. Service Manual Combined with Twelve Concepts for World Service / 2018-20 Ed. / Pg. S116



## CONCEPTS III (3)



X D I S C U S S I O N B I W I L M S A K  
 R T O D Y W G S G P M V B L Q L T P A N  
 B R S K U S M W U B H X D L T P H I J Q  
 W A G I B N M D L F H W E Q S N O R S Z  
 D D Q O C G Q F Q Q F O M Y S I U I P S  
 H I P J V I E U B B Z I O L V W G T L K  
 A T V M E E P Z A P I B C D Y Z H L Z S  
 B I O A P P R U F L S B R I C O T O R T  
 E O T K R Z M N N U I V A V E I D B E P  
 T N E W Q X D C M I X F T I P N D S S E  
 U O E A G V C A C E T O I X T C T E E R  
 C O N F E R E N C E N I C E Q I R R R I  
 O Z F P X P J Q V N D T V O D T Z V V L  
 V H L P A U T H O R I T Y E O E V E E O  
 A S Q Z P R I N C I P L E C K M H D G U  
 C Y B J V K I X F O I U B B V E P S H U  
 T C A C T I O N Z J Y L Y X Y N S S Z S  
 I C C R Y I O W G H Y R U S O T A X Q Y  
 O M R M C O N T R O V E R S Y M S P T O  
 N B W L M N S W D F H L U E B G F Z I C

UNQUALIFIED

CONTROVERSY

CONFERENCE

DEMOCRATIC

INCITEMENT

GOVERNMENT

DISCUSSION

PERILOUS

SUFFICIENT

PRINCIPLE

AUTHORITY

PUNITIVE

TRADITION

THOUGHT

ACTION

OBSERVE

RESERVE

ACTION

SPIRIT

VOTE